Northwind Labs Employee Handbook (2026 edition)

1. Working Hours

Core working hours at Northwind Labs are 10:30 AM to 4:30 PM IST, Monday to Friday. Outside core hours, employees may plan their day freely as long as they complete 40 hours per week.

Team meetings should not be scheduled before 10:30 AM or after 5:30 PM unless every attendee agrees in advance.

2. Leave Policy

Full-time employees receive 18 days of paid annual leave per calendar year. Up to 6 unused days can be carried forward to the next year; any remaining days lapse on 31 December.

Sick leave is separate from annual leave. Employees get 10 days of paid sick leave per year. A medical certificate is required only when sick leave exceeds 3 consecutive days.

Parental leave is 26 weeks for the primary caregiver and 4 weeks for the secondary caregiver. Parental leave requests should be submitted to HR at least 8 weeks before the expected start date.

Leave requests are submitted through the PeopleDesk portal and must be approved by the reporting manager. Requests for 5 or more consecutive days should be raised at least 2 weeks in advance.

3. Remote Work

Employees may work remotely up to 3 days per week. Tuesdays and Thursdays are office anchor days, when everyone is expected in the Hyderabad office unless they are travelling for work.

Fully remote arrangements need written approval from the department head and HR, and are reviewed every 6 months.

Northwind provides a one-time home office allowance of Rs. 15,000 for furniture or equipment, claimable within the first 90 days of joining.

4. Expenses and Reimbursement

Business expenses must be claimed within 30 days of the expense date through the Expensify portal, with an itemised receipt attached.

Claims under Rs. 5,000 are approved by the reporting manager. Claims of Rs. 5,000 or more also need approval from the finance team.

Approved reimbursements are paid with the next monthly payroll, which runs on the last working day of each month.

Domestic travel must be booked in economy class. Hotel stays are capped at Rs. 6,000 per night in metro cities and Rs. 4,000 per night elsewhere.

5. Learning and Development

Each employee has an annual learning budget of Rs. 40,000 that can be used for courses, certifications, books and conference tickets.

Employees who use more than Rs. 25,000 of the learning budget on a single certification agree to stay with the company for 6 months after completing it, or repay the amount on a pro-rata basis.

6. Performance Reviews

Performance reviews happen twice a year, in April and October. Each review includes a self-assessment, manager feedback, and peer feedback from at least two colleagues.

Salary revisions are decided in the April cycle and take effect from 1 May.